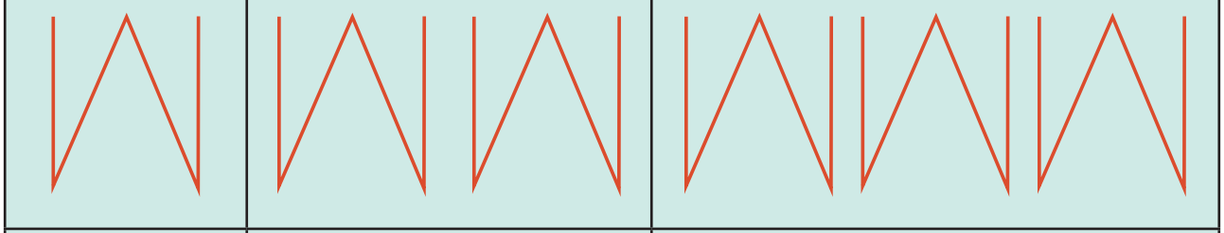
So, we can say that the same will happen for other numbers too.

You will find that Algebra is interesting and useful in solving problems in our daily life such as

- Finding the number of things to its cost.
- Expressing the distance covered, in terms of speed and time.
- Converting miles into kilometres, grams to kilograms etc.
- Finding the length of the barbed wire to fence a garden.
- Finding the area of a park.
- Finding the missing numbers in a sequence.

MATHEMATICS ALIVE – ALGEBRA IN REAL LIFE



4 sticks	8 sticks	12 sticks
1 × 4 sticks	2 × 4 sticks	3 × 4 sticks

2.2 Patterns

Mathematics is easy when we look at it as a study of patterns. Patterns allow us to make reasonable guesses. Understanding patterns provide a clear basis for problem solving skills. In this chapter, we are going to look at patterns that deals with numbers. For example, let us list the numbers we know in order

1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9, 10...

We observe that 1 is odd, 2 is even, 3 is odd, 4 is even etc. Thus odd numbers and even numbers alternate with each other. If these is a sequence 12, 8, 4 ... can you find the next number? Easy, each number is obtained by subtracting 4 from the previous number. So the fourth number is 0.

The branch of Mathematics that deals with such patterns is called Algebra. Today Algebra is used widely in many fields that include banking, insurance, accounting, statistics, science, engineering, manufacturing and so on.

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